

iQOO 11 5G

Power on a BMW Platter

The iQOO 11 is a beast of a performer. It comes with bleeding-edge specs. So naturally, we were super excited to get our hands on the phone. Here's our review –

DESIGN

Starting with the basics, the design of the iQOO 11 5G is beautiful. While it is your traditional glass-slab form factor, the back panel is draped in beautiful white faux leather, with the BMW M Motorsport racing stripes running down from the right side of the back panel. Up front, things are rather simple. It has a metal frame, which gives you a more reinforced and dense in-hand feel. The display, however, doesn't flow in the frame seamlessly and looks stuck on, adding more edges to where the display meets the frame. Overall, this is a very nice design from iQOO and the in-hand feel is extremely premium.

DISPLAY

Coming to display, this is the first smartphone to launch with an E6 AMOLED display, which means this is probably the best display on any smartphone in the country so far. The response is slick with the 144Hz refresh rate. While we are not sure that the refresh rate is a full 144Hz while scrolling through the interface, it surely feels super slick. In the "vivid" or "bright" display settings especially, the contrast is really off, and the colours are too saturated. The skin tone is really off, with blown-up reds in vivid display settings. However, in the "natural" display setting, the colour accuracy is pretty good. We compared the display with iPhone 14 Pro Max, our benchmark, and the colours were pretty much the same, but only in certain colour settings apart from the "vivid" or "bright" settings. In terms of detail, this display is very good. Be it watching content or playing games, the details on this display are superb.

PERFORMANCE

In terms of performance, the iQOO 11



5G is overkill in every sense of the word. It is the first smartphone in India to come with the Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 chip. Pair that with 16GB of RAM, and you get a very capable smartphone. On AnTuTu, the smartphone showed one of the highest scores ever at 1,272,241. On Geekbench 5 also, it showed impressive performance but lagged behind the A16 Bionic-powered Apple iPhone 14 Pro Max. Other CPU benchmark tests like PCMark Work 2.0, and the phone lagged behind other higher-end smartphones like the iPhone 14 Pro Max and the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 4. Further, GPU benchmarks showed better performance than the above-mentioned smartphones. In storage speed tests, the iQOO 5G blew the competition out of the water. This is due to the new UFS 4.0 storage used on the phone.

BATTERY

Coming to the battery, it also has impressive battery optimisation. In our video loop test, the smartphone lasted for over 15 hours while playing a video in full HD resolution at full brightness. The charging on the iQOO 11 5G is also super fast. The

120W fast charger was able to charge the iQOO 11 5G from 0 to 100 in just over 27 minutes. Overall, the battery experience of this smartphone is very good and it's tough to imagine any kind of user asking for more out of the battery.

CAMERA

Coming to cameras, while it is a very good shooter for ideal lighting conditions like a studio or bright outdoors, in a lot of environments, the camera blows up the colours. Although there are features like a natural mode that puts out more true-to-life images with minimal processing, without it, the images are more vibrant and the colours seem slightly blown up. There's very minimal colour shift while switching from primary to wide-angle lens. The wide-angle shooter doesn't produce detailed images as the primary shooter does. The telephoto lens is good and does the job without losing much detail. The

portrait mode on the iQOO 11 5G is good and the front camera is also decent. The skin tones are accurate, but it at times overprocesses the images and lacks detail in many shots.

VERDICT

The iQOO 11 5G is nothing short of a beast in terms

of performance and gives an idea of what 2023 has in store for us in terms of smartphones, especially in the top-tier. Everything about the smartphone looks and feels premium and top-notch. The software, however, is not the best we have seen and the cameras don't match up to the smartphone's performance chops. Overall, the experience is just super smooth.

–Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 SoC | GPU: Adreno 740 | OS: Funtouch OS 13 based on Android 13 | Display: 6.78-inch 2K LTPO 4 AMOLED display | RAM: Up to 16GB | ROM: Up to 256GB UFS 4.0 | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 13MP + 8MP | Cameras (front): 16MP | Battery: 5000mAh

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